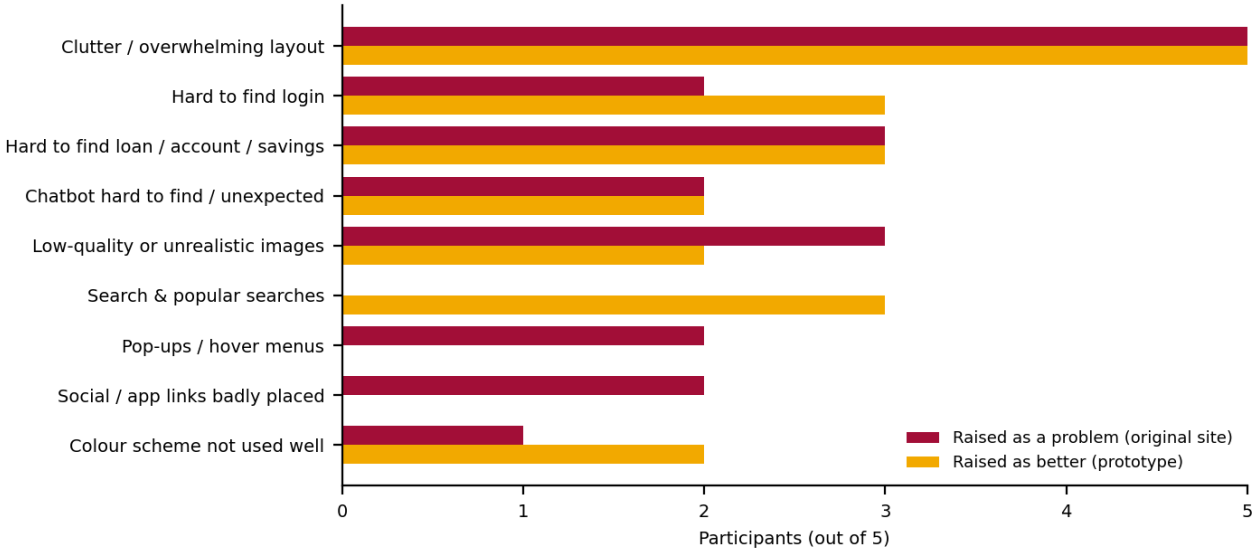
Usability Study: Original PNB Website vs. Redesigned Prototype

Final Conclusion Report | Nisarg Ghule (PRN 1252243177) | October 2026

1. Study overview

Five participants (batchmates) compared the original Punjab National Bank (PNB) website with my high-fidelity Figma prototype. Each gave a recorded, think-aloud review of the overall experience rather than one fixed task. Audio was converted to text, lightly cleaned for grammar, and coded for recurring themes. The chart and table show how many of the 5 participants raised each theme.

2. Qualitative findings



Frustration with the original site	Evidence (participant)	Resolved in prototype?
Cluttered, overwhelming, messy	All 5. Also noted as hard for older users (Paraansh).	**Yes.** Described as simpler, minimal, with enough spacing.
Login hard to find	N. Malhotra: about 2 minutes to find it. Archita could not find it.	**Yes.** Login immediately visible, top right (N. Malhotra, Archita, Jashna).
Loan / savings / investment options buried	N. Malhotra, Archita, Jashna	**Yes.** Savings, credit card and home loan sections visible on the homepage.
Chatbot appears unexpectedly or is hard to find	N. Malhotra, Archita	**Yes.** Placed on the right and clearly identifiable.
Pop-ups and hover-triggered menus	Archita, Siddhi	**Yes.** Not raised as an issue on the prototype.
Pixelated or AI-looking images	N. Malhotra, Archita, Paraansh	**Yes.** Clearer, more realistic photography (family hero image).
Slow, long forms; excess scrolling and ads	Jashna	**Yes.** Described as faster, smoother and more compact.

New features participants valued (not present on the original): a search bar with popular searches (3 of 5), an AI-style message box, a screen-reader option and language options (Paraansh), and a login page that reuses the red and yellow brand colours (N. Malhotra, Siddhi). **What the original did well:** its chatbot is interactive and the red-yellow palette has potential (Paraansh, N. Malhotra).

3. Conclusion

On the qualitative evidence, **the prototype successfully improved the user experience.** All five participants preferred it. The main complaints about the original (clutter, hard-to-find login, loan and account options, a poorly placed chatbot, and weak imagery) were each addressed. The strongest signal is clutter: it was raised by 5 of 5 participants, and all 5 said the redesign felt simpler and more organised. Login findability is the clearest measurable gain: one participant reported about two minutes to find login on the original, versus immediate on the prototype.

4. Limitations

The study used five participants, mostly batchmates, who gave overall impressions of the experience rather than timed, identical tasks. The prototype is a Figma mock-up, whereas the original is a live website, so findings reflect perceived usability rather than measured task performance. Transcripts were cleaned for grammar and speech-to-text errors; participants' opinions were preserved.